



Both the Omega and its sibling Delta do not look cheap despite being so

Before you reach for the taser, you can do away with the distraction by getting noise cancelling headphones! You need to strike the right balance between budget and effectiveness, and we recommend the Brainwavz Delta, or its slightly cheaper cousin, the Brainwavz Omega

DODGE THAT POWERCUT

Powercuts are a part of hostel life, and some of us may be rich enough to afford colleges where even the hostels have inverters and generators, however, our guess is most of you won't be those lucky few. You're going to need lights, no matter what, because you need to see to do almost anything that people do in hostels (What? We did say almost!). Cooling can also be a serious requirement, because it's often impossible to think straight when you're literally being fried in your own sweat... Get a powerbank and some USB lights and fans, and you will thank us for as long as you live. Just remember to make sure the powerbank itself is regularly charged.

SOLVE THEM IOUS

Hostel mates are super chatty and attentive and fun to talk to, until the bill arrives. Then suddenly everyone's busy tying their shoelaces, examining the menu, staring off into space, and counting the amount of lines on the striped tablecloth! If you find yourself picking up the tab more often than you'd like to, which you will, you need to get apps such as Splitwise or Mypoolin. These apps help keep tabs of who owes who how much money, and there's no convenient forgetting about

the amounts anymore. Some of us would have paid off our student loans a few years earlier had we had these apps in our time.

TRACK THAT INVADER

Be prepared to learn some interesting new smells in hostels. How does someone smell when they haven't showered in two weeks? What do socks used consecutively for a month smell like? You will find out... Get a UV light, so that you can check for human "influences" in your room and all over your stuff. Unless you're the one who doesn't bathe or change clothes...

JUGAAD!

Need to dry a shirt quickly? Turn the trusty microwave into a dryer. You will need to use the lowest power setting, and take it out, shake it a bit and turn it inside out about every 30 seconds or so. And remember no metal, no elastic and no synthetic fabrics. No mirror in the hostel? Use your laptop webcam to shave. Starving at midnight after the kitchen is locked? Get some instant noodles and cook it on your clothes iron (figure out a safe stand for it and call yourself jugaad king henceforth), and behold! Your new cooktop!



Not exactly Gourmet food, but often just what you need!

FOOL THE WARDEN

Sometimes, a strict warden can be a bigger roadblock to your weekend plans than hail and hellfire. Rather than taking that as a disappointment, take it as a challenge. Download a voice modification app and pretend to be, well, someone who is authorized to speak to the warden. Of course, be ready for a thrashing later!

BREATHE SAFE

More often than not, in your hostel life you might encounter people who are quite significant contributors to...err... air pollution, even if you make it clear that you have a problem with that. Rather than getting

into an endless debate with someone who has already decided to kill themselves slowly, you need to get yourself a portable air purifier. And, of course, rely on one of mankind's most technologically advanced architectural innovations to breathe – Windows, not the Microsoft kind.

VISUALISE YOUR DREAM HOSTEL

With smartphones hitting the market with integrated support for Augmented Reality, we can't really say that AR is still far away. And what better (and less expensive) way to live in a hostel of your dreams? Although you might still have to develop the necessary software that would change the walls, the ceiling, the fans and pretty much everything around you to make an AR environment, it would still be worth it. For some of you, it might be the only way to stay sane, and prevent you from questioning the very purpose of your life, and planning on running away to the Himalayas for some serenity.

SAVE SOME MONEY

We do realise that we have recommended a bunch of expensive ways to survive hostel life to you. And being former hostelites ourselves, we know the perennial state of being broke quite well. Don't worry, we've got your back there too. There are a number of financial planning apps that integrate with your phone's SMS application to detect any transaction that generates a text message to your number. It then categorises these expenses and generates reports to show you exactly where you are overspending and where you can save more. Even if you do not transact online or via card much, you still have the option to enter your spending manually. Do it at the end of the day and see those savings magically pile up! A few of the easy ones are Walnut, Mint and Moneyfy.

BUCKLE UP

Despite all we've said, hostel life isn't all bad, and some of the best memories and best friends you will ever have await you in your hostel. Just follow the tips we've given you and you will live through your first year. It's all down hill after that! Plus, never fear when you have tech by your side. If there's a problem you think we missed solving, remember to write in and tell us. 